11.2 Highlights of Tamil Nadu Economy

- Growth of SGDP in Tamil Nadu has been among the fastest in India since 2005.
- Poverty reduction in Tamil Nadu has been faster than that in many other States.
- Tamil Nadu contains a smaller proportion of India's poor population.
- Tamil Nadu is the second largest contributor to India's GDP.
- Tamil Nadu ranks 3rd in Human Development Index (source: UNDP-2015)
- Tamil Nadu ranks 3rd in terms of invested capital (₹2.92 lakh crore) and value of total industrial output (₹6.19 lakh crore).
- Tamil Nadu ranks first among the states in terms of number of factories with 17% share and industrial workers (16% share) of the country.
- Tamil Nadu is placed third in health index as per the NITI AAYOG report.
- Tamil Nadu has a highest Gross Enrolment Ratio in higher education.
- Tamil Nadu has the largest number of engineering colleges
- Tamil Nadu has emerged as a major hub for renewable energy.
- Tamil Nadu has highest credit Deposit Ratio in commercial and Cooperative banks.
- Tamil Nadu has ranks first on investment proposals filed by MSMEs.

11.3 Performance of Tamil Nadu Economy

Some of the States like Gujarat and Maharashtra seem to perform well in some of the economic indicators. Kerala tops in literacy, IMR and MMR. In recent years Tamil Nadu's performance is outstanding and far ahead of all other states in the spheres of health, higher education, growth of MSMEs, poverty alleviation and employment generation.

Tamil Nadu is placed third in health index

The Tamil Nadu state has come third after Kerala and Punjab in a health index report. The neo natal mortality rate is 14 lower than that of many other states and that the under 5 mortality has dropped from 21 in 2014 to 20 in 2015

- Healthy States, Progressive India Report, (2018) –NITI AAYOG

The reasons for the relative success of Tamil Nadu lie in extending social policies to cover most of the population. For instance the Public Distribution System, midday meals and public health infrastructure have near universal coverage.

11.4 Natural Resources

11.4.1 Water Resources

Tamil Nadu is not endowed with rich natural resources compared to other

Chapter-11.indd 227 1/2/2023 11:55:34 AM